

GETTING IT TOGETHER

NITIE Mumbai was set up way back in 1963 with assistance from the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and the International Labour Organization (ILO). It was later renamed the National Institute of Industrial Engineering. The reason for setting it up was clear and, most importantly, relevant to the period.

“It was to train industrial engineers for a manufacturing renaissance,” explains Shashi Kiran Shetty, Chairman of the Board of Governance of IIM Mumbai and Founder and Chairman of the

logistics major Allcargo Group. In fact, it only admitted engineers in those days. That was a very different era, when the newly-Independent India embarked on a path of rapid industrialisation, setting up factories to create a robust foundation for the new nation. In keeping with the priorities of those times, there was a strong emphasis on manufacturing, as it was the obvious route to generate mass employment for a large population and help it transition out of agriculture. A lot has changed in the intervening six decades, and today’s India is clearly very

different, so everything has to be reoriented. NITIE could not be left out.

Shetty believes the time was right for NITIE to join the prestigious list of IIMs. “As a brand, NITIE was very strong, but in the dynamic world that we live in, a change was required,” he says. Manoj K. Tiwari, the institute’s Director, who had a 17-year stint as a professor in the department of industrial engineering and management at IIT Kharagpur, adds that an institute has to evolve with the times. “We got the maximum benefit out of the NITIE brand name and were ready to look ahead,” he says.

There were limitations to growth as well. NITIE came under the Ministry of Education and was looking for some autonomy. Shetty says he travelled to Delhi several times to convince officials in the government that the transformation to IIM Mumbai was critical. Understandably, the process took time since it needed to go through an Act of Parliament before getting the go-ahead from the PMO and finally the President of India. He does not hold back on crediting the government by saying they have brought about a transformation in education. “The forward-looking approach has been encouraging,” says Shetty, who recollects receiving a call from the government during the pandemic and being offered the position at NITIE.

“Our focus is now completely on the students and campus. With a better ranking and 100% placement, we are well set for the next round of growth,” says Tiwari, sitting in the conference room that offers a great view of the Vihar Lake, with the famed IIT Mumbai’s Powai campus just a short drive away. Tiwari’s academic background and Shetty’s business

IIM MUMBAI AT A GLANCE

Placement performance	₹30.39 lakh per annum (LPA) average in 2024
Campus experience	● The 70-acre lush green campus, which is located in Powai with scenic views of the Vihar Lake and Sanjay Gandhi National Park, is equipped with residential facilities
New Initiatives (digital / entrepreneurship)	● IIM Mumbai has launched a two-year executive MBA online programme, besides a two-year programme on maritime logistics and supply chain, and a one-year PGPEX on logistics and operations excellence through digitisation. These courses stand out as a significant milestone, offering working professionals the opportunity to pursue high-impact learning, research and its application in industry ● It has partnered with Motilal Oswal Financial Services to foster financial research and equip its students with a collaborative curriculum to gain a competitive edge and prepare ethically ready investment management professionals ● IIM Mumbai has also launched online certification courses like ‘Generative AI for Business Decisions’ taught by David Simchi-Levi from Massachusetts Institute of Technology, US, and Manoj K. Tiwari, Director of IIM Mumbai, which helps participants gain an advantage in the technology management front ● It has partnered with Stardust, a European ASD (Aerospace, New Space and Defence) accelerator, to provide vital support and resources to start-ups in the sector